



About Desk Accessories

The Apple IIGS supports two different kinds of desk accessories. Desk accessories are the electronic equivalent of the tools you keep on your real desk—things like calculators, notepads, and calendars—that are usually kept to the side of your regular work but are always available at a moment's notice. (To the computer, of course, desk accessories are just more programs.)

Classic Desk Accessories, also called CDAs or text desk accessories, use the IIGS's text screen (the screen used by AppleWorks and most older programs). Most are accessible from both Desktop and non-Desktop programs. To see a list of available CDAs, hold down ⌘ and Control while pressing and releasing Escape.

New Desk Accessories, also called NDAs or graphic desk accessories, appear in windows in your Desktop programs. NDAs are listed in your  menu.

Desk accessories (both NDAs and CDAs) are installed by placing them in the Desk.Accs folder inside your startup disk's System folder. After you install any desk accessories, you must restart the computer before they are available for your use.

▲ **By The Way...**

If you bought the Quality Computers System 6 Bonus Pack, there's a Finder Extension called IR that allows you to install desk accessories without having to restart, and without the desk accessories needing to be in the Desk.Accs folder. Keep reading for more details.

Finder extensions are similar to NDAs.—they're essentially desk accessories that work only in the Finder. Instead of appearing in your  menu, Finder Extensions appear in the Finder's Extras menu (which appears only if you have installed one or more Finder Extensions). Finder extensions are installed by placing them in the System.Setup folder inside your startup disk's System folder.

▲ **By The Way...**

Finder extensions can also be placed in a folder called FinderExtras—this folder doesn't exist on a normal System disk, so you must create one first. Finder extensions installed in the FinderExtras folder only use memory while you're in the Finder but cause the Finder to take longer to start up; extensions in the System.Setup folder use memory all the time but don't slow down the Finder.